My distraught alarm was such that on the obstetric floor the joke went around, "Gertrude did not have a miscarriage, but Isaac had five." Such delightful humor!

At any rate, they wouldn't keep her any longer and swore to me that she would not have a miscarriage, so I brought her home on January 30.

After that scare, we felt we had to take it easy, and the dictate-and-transcribe routine stopped and never restarted. Too bad! We had something good going there.

The thing I remember most about that three-month period of dic-tate-and-transcribe was Gertrude coming in with one of the thin blue-green records and saying, "I can't transcribe this."

"Why not?" I said.

"Well, listen to it."

I listened. It was a scene in which two characters were arguing and the argument grew steadily more heated. And as it grew more heated, so did my voice, until, at the peak, I was not dictating but snarling incoherently.

I had to repeat the entire passage, making an effort to remain cool. I had never realized up to then how closely I mimicked the emotions of my characters.

10

All through this period—indeed, ever since the kidney-stone episode ten weeks before—I had been living with dull pains and uncomfortable urination, and had steadfastly refused any thought of going to the hospital and being probed or catheterized.

Finally, on January 31, 1951, I felt the kind of pain that I could associate with only one thing. I grasped for the jar, which I was too lazy to use all the time, and urinated into it. The pain was like a hot spear being shoved through the urethra from the inside out. After I stopped hopping about and groaning I looked at the jar and there was the stone. It was a little over a quarter inch long and about an eighth of an inch wide, yellow-brown in color, and very jagged.

I took it in to school. Dr. Walker said he had never seem so large a kidney stone passed (news I greeted without enthusiasm, since I saw no benefit to